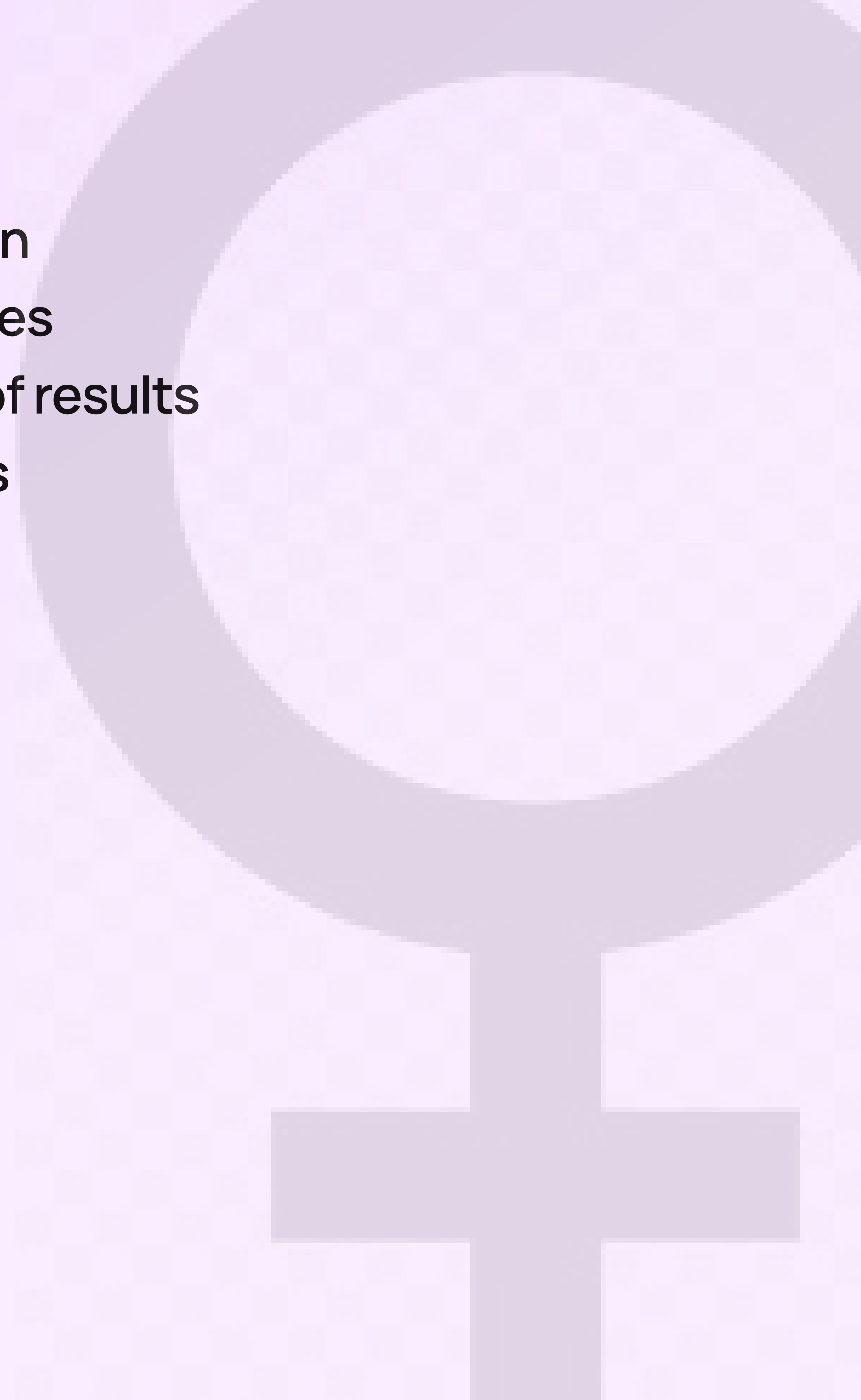


Medical PCOS and Reddit

APRIL 22, 2026

- 01 Introduction
- 02 Data sources
- 03 Summary of results
- 04 Challenges



01

PCOS

Also known as Polycystic ovary syndrome, is a common hormonal disorder in women of reproductive age is a leading cause of female infertility and metabolic issues.

While it affects 1 in 10 women, it remains one of the most misunderstood and misdiagnosed hormonal conditions.

**Does medical
symptoms match
with Reddit real-
life experience?**

02 I focused on similar features on both data sources.

Kaggle

541 patients

1. PCOS (Y/N)
2. Cycle (R/I)
3. Cycle length (days)
4. Weight gain (Y/N)
5. Hair growth (Y/N)
6. Skin darkening (Y/N)
7. Hair loss (Y/N)
8. Pimples (Y/N)
9. Fast food (Y/N)

r/PCOS

~300 posts

- User-generated discussions
- Extracted symptoms from titles + text
- Keyword-based symptom frequency analysis

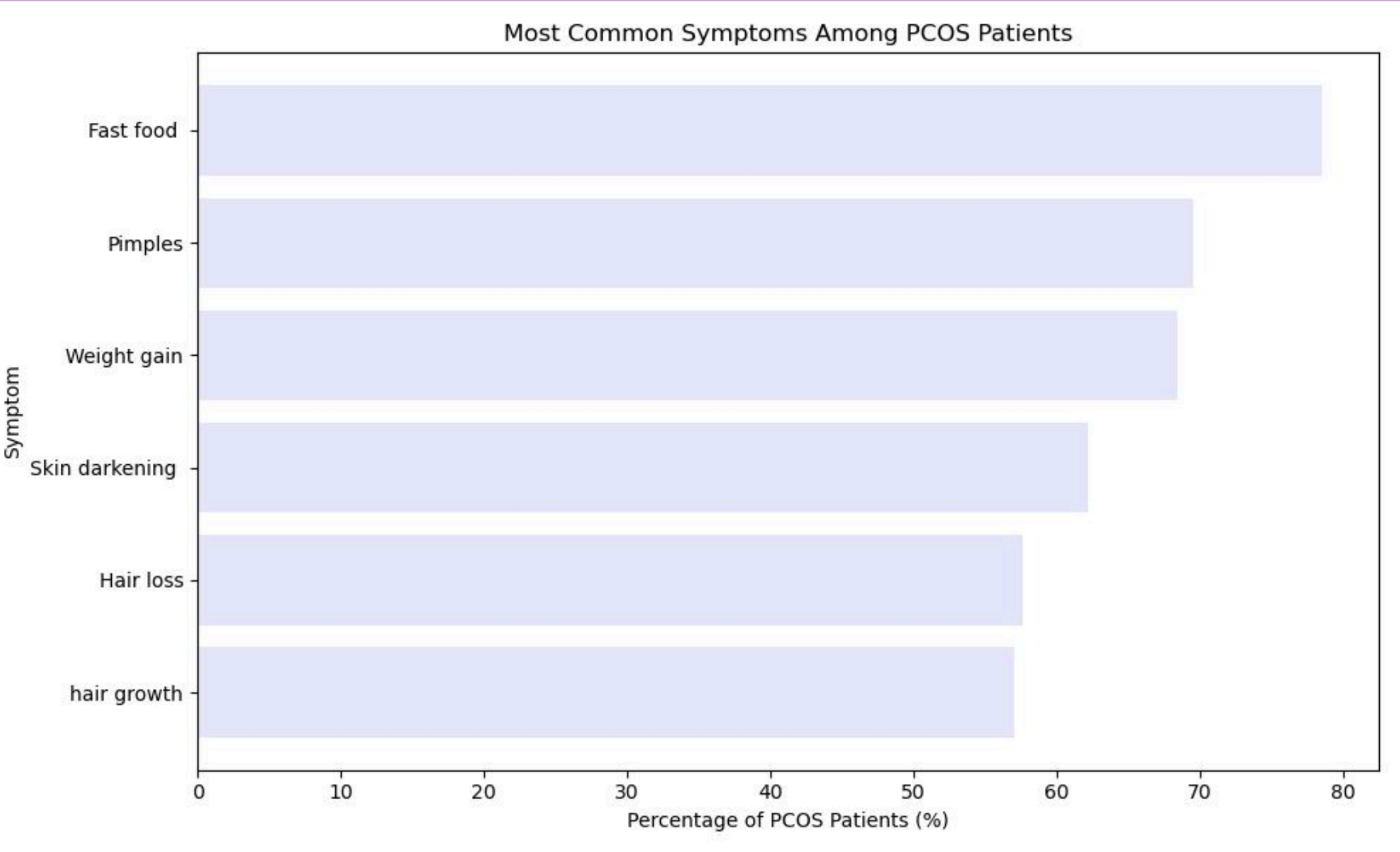
+

I will add another dataset that will speak to diet and lifestyle that are common.

To get a bigger full picture of a women's lifestyle choices influencing PCOS diagnosis

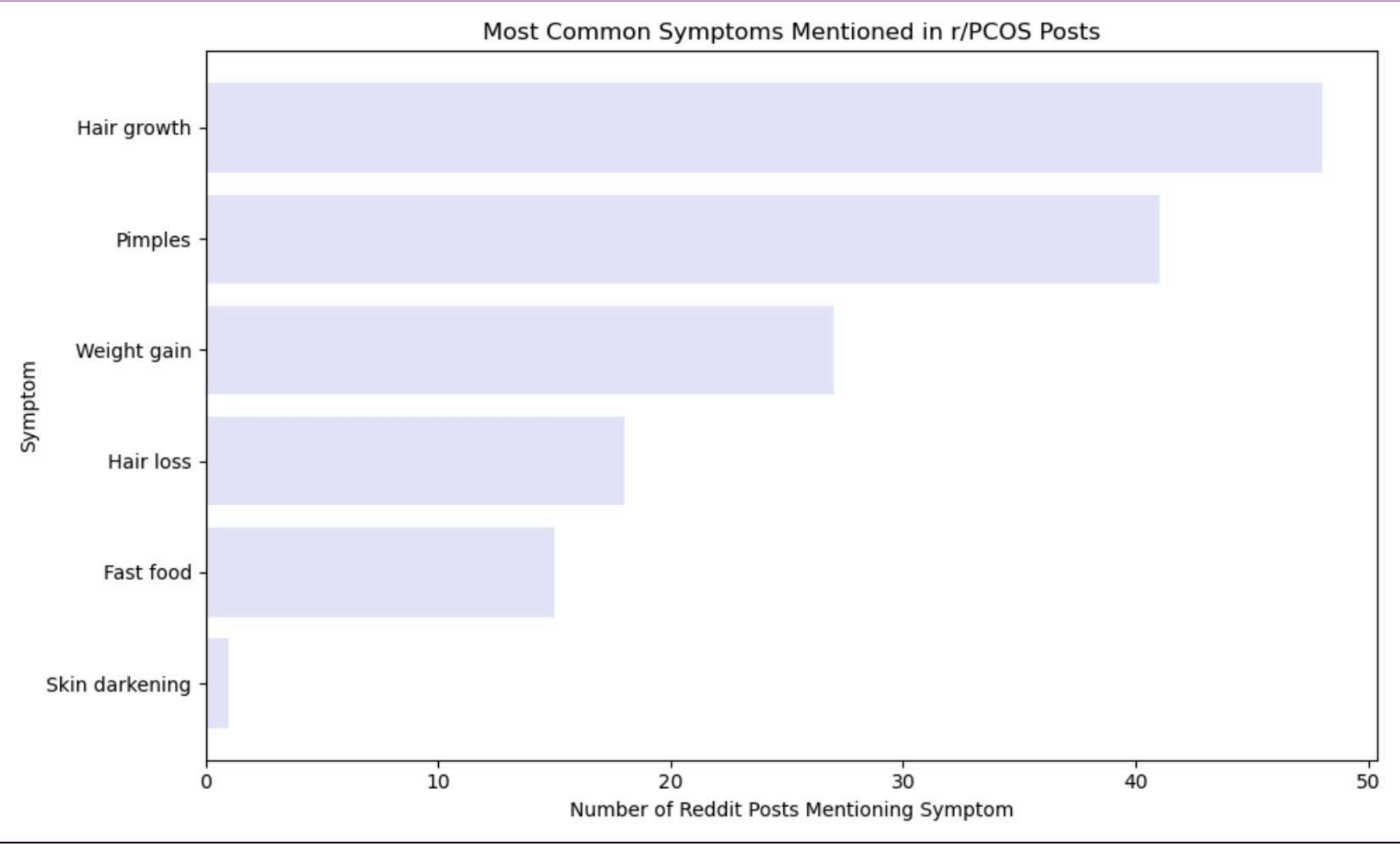
03a top 3

fast food
pimples
weight gain.



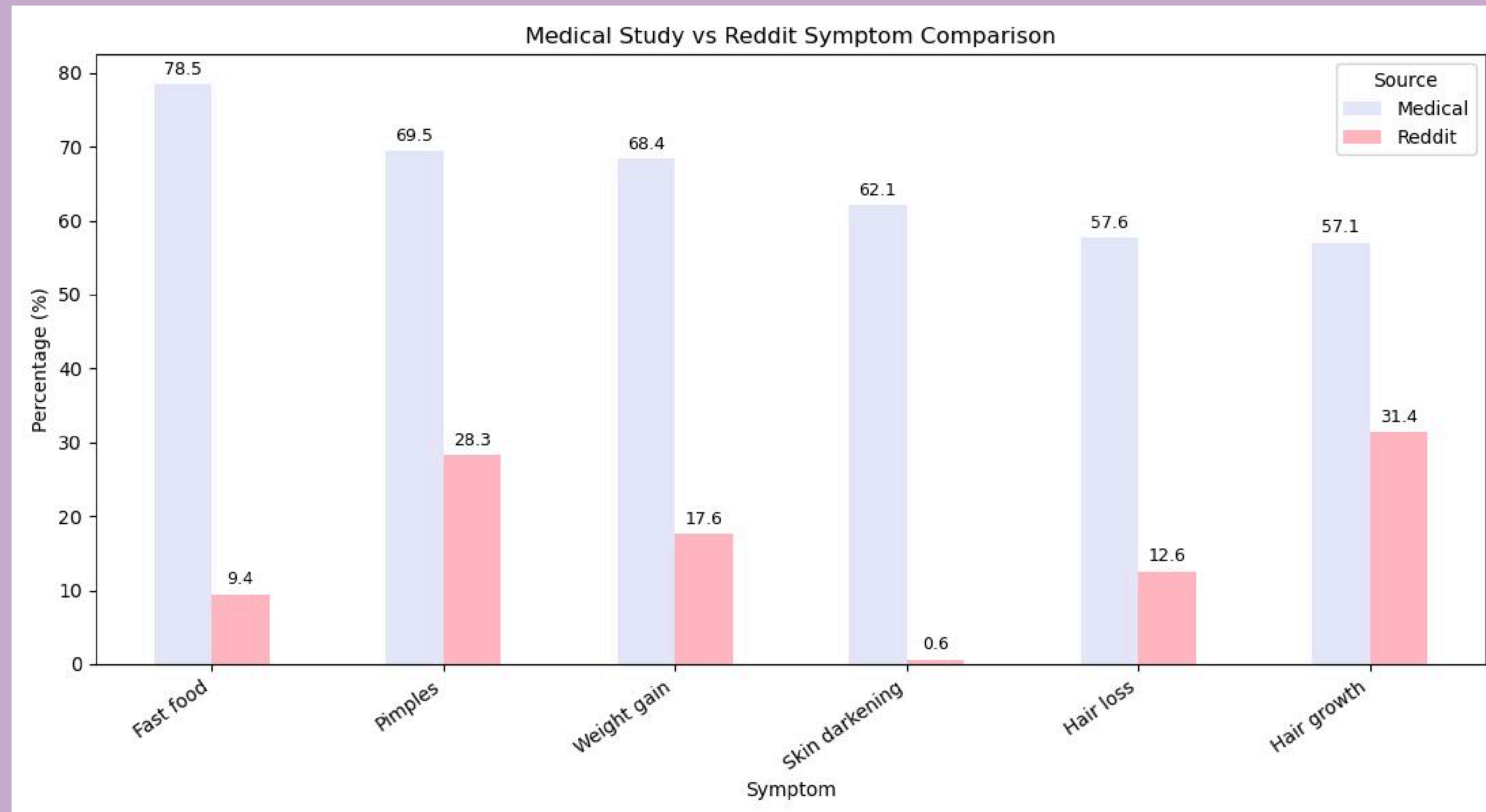
Kaggle Study

r/PCOS forum



hair growth
pimples
weight gain

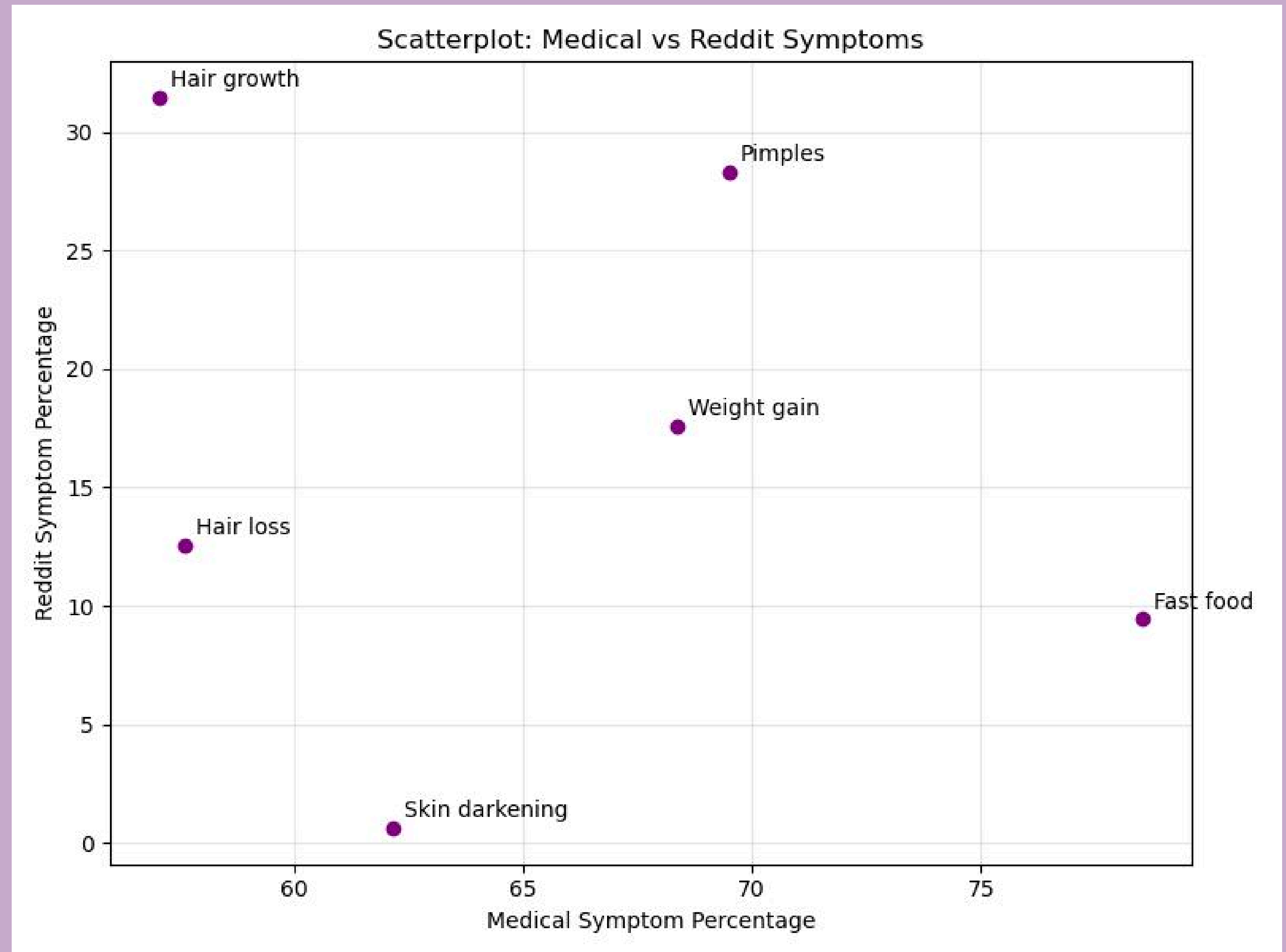
03b comparatively, not all clinically common symptoms are widely discussed



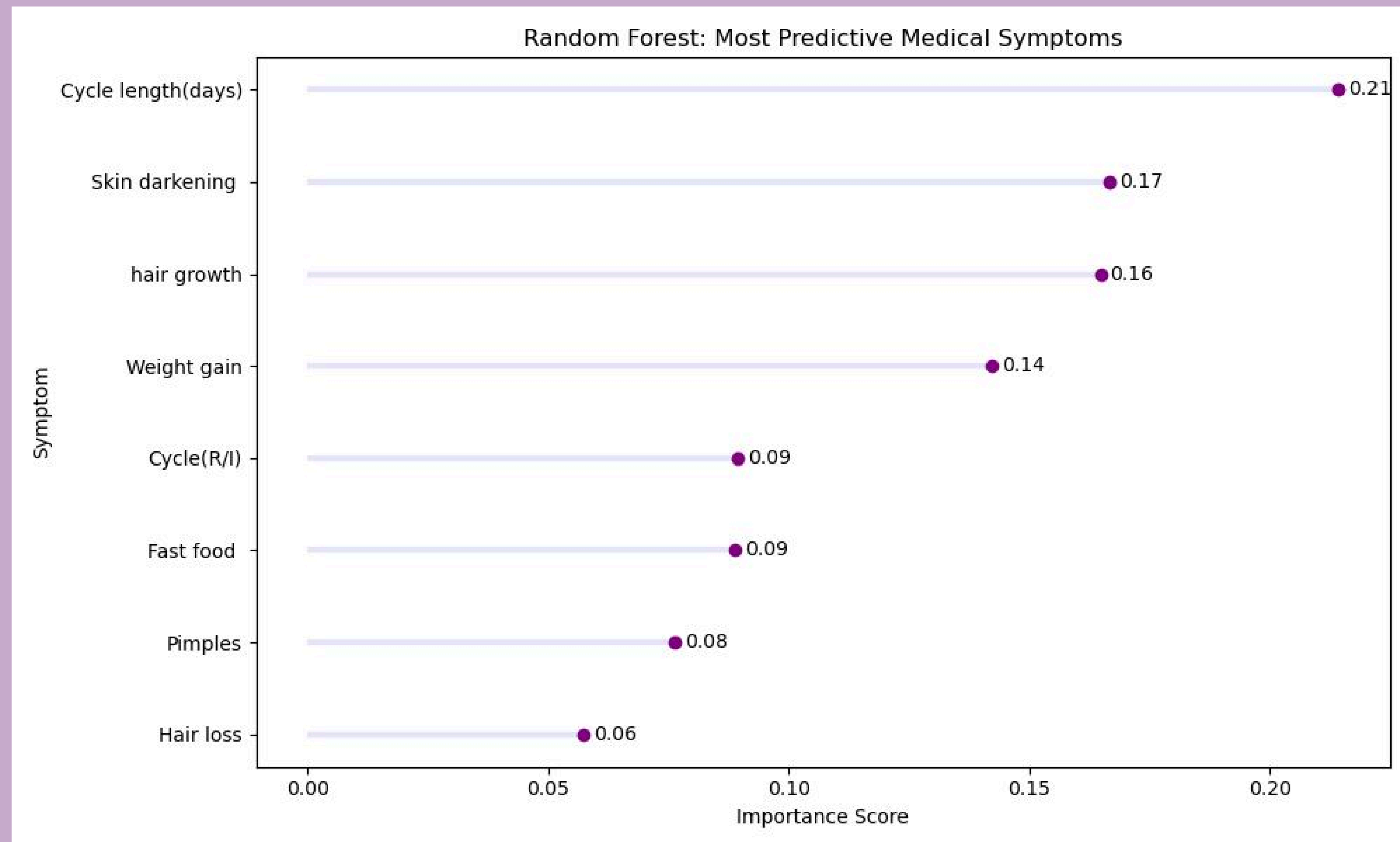
- skin darkening high clinically, rarely discussed
- hair growth & pimples overrepresented on Reddit
- fast food common clinically, less discussed online

03c little to no clear correlation between clinical prevalence and Reddit discussion.

- no clear linear pattern
- points are scattered
- some symptoms are outliers (hair growth, skin darkening)



03d used Random Forest to identify key predictors of PCOS within the clinical dataset



- Found that features like cycle length and skin darkening are strong predictors of PCOS
- Key predictors of PCOS differ from both the most common and most discussed symptoms.

04

Challenges

- Google Trends Many errors, had to change my source (too late)
- r/PCOS:Scope Realized I had to narrow my project to analyzing symptoms that were negative ONLY, and filtering it (many data sets)
- .main & .config Putting everything together, DEBUGGING

More women's research needs to be done.